Investigation report

Are more users new, retained or returning?

Which group is largest each month?

Data

Authorized synthetic SQLite
May–September 2026 UTC

Snapshot

2026-09-30T23:59:59Z, metadata assertion
Build 3a0dbed21d2f45958aefa2887a0cadd8

Run

Independent
2026-11-09
10 read-only queries

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How to read this report

- Each numbered check refers to a SQL evidence log.
- Counts are distinct identified active users within each month.

Terms used in this report

Term	Meaning
New	Active and signed up in the month.
Retained	Active in this month and the previous month.
Returning	Active this month, not the previous month, and signed up earlier; called resurrected in the registry.

01. Chapter

The answer

01

Retained users are the largest group in every month from May to September 2026. In September, 5,071 (44.3%) were retained, 4,656 (40.7%) returning, and 1,720 (15.0%) new. (Checks 4 and 6)

Coverage Unidentified sessions are excluded. September had 3,703 such sessions, whose distinct users and categories are unknown. (Checks 5 and 10)

Data snapshot 2026-09-30T23:59:59Z, metadata assertion · build 3a0dbed21d2f45958aefa2887a0cadd8 · 10 read-only queries

02. Chapter
How we investigated
02

What data we used

- Growth accounting v1.0 and MAU v1.1; UTC months use inclusive start, exclusive next-month start. April lacks a growth row because March is outside the coverage window.
- Gold was reconciled at build and independently recounted from Silver for September.

Investigation path

- Checked database inventory, metadata, build, monthly results, Silver recount, identity coverage and quality.
- The comparison directly answers the question; no causal hypotheses were tested.

03. Chapter
What happened
03

The movement

Month	New	Retained	Returning	MAU
May	2,201 (24.1%)	4,757 (52.1%)	2,176 (23.8%)	9,134
June	2,653 (26.6%)	4,867 (48.8%)	2,456 (24.6%)	9,976
July	2,477 (24.4%)	4,753 (46.9%)	2,908 (28.7%)	10,138
August	2,949 (27.1%)	4,415 (40.6%)	3,507 (32.3%)	10,871
September	1,720 (15.0%)	5,071 (44.3%)	4,656 (40.7%)	11,447

- Percentages use the same month’s identified MAU; rounding may affect totals. Do not sum distinct users across months. (Check 4)

Who drove it

- September MAU rose by 576 from August: 1,720 new + 4,656 returning − 5,800 churned = 576. Churned means active in August but not September. (Check 4)
- Of September returning users, 157 had their first observed session in September despite earlier signup. (Check 6)

04. Chapter
Why it happened
04

- No cause is established by these counts.

05. Chapter
Data quality and limits
05

Data quality

- September’s 3,703 unidentified sessions include one beginning in August. Session counts are not people; unknown identities could affect the retained–returning gap of 415. (Checks 5 and 10)
- September Silver recount matches Gold. No missing profiles, future signups, duplicate or null user-day keys, flagged activity rows or flagged profiles were found. Thirteen payment corrections are outside this activity metric. (Checks 6, 7, 9)
- Build succeeded and reports passing growth and MAU reconciliation. Current registry hash differs from the build registry hash; same metric versions and the September recount support this result, but full registry equivalence and source freshness were not independently established. (Check 3)

Limitations

- Returning includes people first active after signup month, including those signed up before coverage.
- Metadata snapshot and synthetic completeness are assertions, not a verified database hash or proof of real-world telemetry completeness.
- First five checks were logged before the snapshot was known; check 2 records its value. Repository has no Git metadata: local directory timestamp 2026-11-09 20:12:48 IST is a copy-date proxy, not a verified download date.

06. Chapter
What to do next
06

- Track buckets and identity coverage together; improve linkage before extrapolating to all visitors.
- If only previously active reactivations should count as returning, agree the definition and recompute.

Appendix

Evidence appendix

A

Check	Evidence	Layer
1–3	Inventory, metadata and build	Metadata
4–5	Growth and MAU coverage	Gold
6–10	Recount, quality, identity and boundaries	Silver